SUPPLEMENTARY MATERIAL 2

Where included studies differed in measuring units used for glycated hemoglobin (HbA1c), fasting blood glucose, and other biomarkers these were converted to enable comparison. The following formulas were applied:

Fasting Blood Glucose (Table 1): Three studies reported fasting blood glucose in milligrams per deciliter (mg/dL), whereas one study[1] measured fasting blood glucose in millimoles per liter (mmol/L). The formula applied for conversion was: mg/dL = 18.01*mmol/l [2,3].

	Baseline M(SD)		**Follow-up (6 months post-intervention) M(SD)**	
	Original (mmol/L)	**Converted (mg/dl)**	**Original (mmol/L)**	**Converted (mg/dl)**
Experimental Intervention	8.0 (3.9)	160.2 (70.2)	8.1 (2.7)	145.8 (48.6)
Control intervention	8.3 (2.9)	149.4 (52.2)	7.8 (2.6)	136.8 (46.8)

Table 1: Unit transformation for Fasting Blood Glucose (Ramadas[1]). M: Mean, SD: Standard Deviation

HDL and LDL lipoprotein-cholesterol (Tables 2 and 3): The two studies that included biomarkers of diabetes complications used different units. Therefore, values in mmol/l were converted to mg/dl using the following formula: mg/dL = 38.67*mmol/l [4]

	Baseline M(SD)		**Follow-up (6 months post-intervention) M(SE)**	
	Original (mmol/L)	**Converted (mg/dl)**	**Original (mmol/L)**	**Converted (mg/dl)**
Experimental Intervention	3.00 (0.90)	116.67 (34.80)	2.66 (0.08)	103.74(3.12)
Control intervention	3.10(0.90)	119.88 (34.80)	2.74 (0.08)	106.86 (3.12)

Table 2: Unit transformation for LDL lipoprotein-cholesterol(Muchiri[5]); M: Mean, SD: Standard Deviation, SE: Standard Error

	Baseline M(SD)		**Follow-up (6 months post-intervention) M(SE)**	
	Original (mmol/L)	**Converted (mg/dl)**	**Original (mmol/L)**	**Converted (mg/dl)**
Experimental Intervention	1.10 (0.27)	42.54 (10.44)	0.99 (0.02)	38.61 (0.78)

Control intervention	1.10 (0.27)	42.54 (10.44)	1.0 (0.03)	39 (1.17)

Table 3: Unit transformation for HDL lipoprotein-cholesterol (Muchiri[5]); M: Mean, SD: Standard deviation, SE: Standard Error

Triglycerides (Table 4): The two studies that included biomarkers of diabetes complications used different units. Therefore, values in mmol/l were converted to mg/dl using the following formula: mg/dL = 88.57*mmol/l[4].

	Baseline M(CI)		**Follow-up (6 months post-intervention) M(CI)**	
	Original (mmol/L)	**Converted (mg/dl)**	**Original (mmol/L)**	**Converted (mg/dl)**
Experimental Intervention	1.40 (1.10 to 1.60)	124 (97.43 to 141.71)	1.30 (1.20 to 1.60)	115.7 (97.90 to 142.40)
Control intervention	1.40 (1.20 to 1.60)	124 (106.28 to 141.71)	1.50 (1.30 to 1.80)	133.5 (115.70 to 160.20)

Table 4: Unit transformation for triglycerides (Muchiri[5]); M: Mean, CI: 95% Confidence Interval

Standard Error/Standard Deviation (Tables 5-11): reporting by Muchiri[5] included standard deviation for baseline values, but standard error for follow-up values.

	Baseline		**Follow-up (6 months post-intervention)**	
	Original M(SD)	**Converted** M(SD)	**Original** M(SE)	**Converted** M(SD)
Experimental Intervention	10.80 (1.80)	NA	9.67 (0.29)	9.67 (1.86)
Control intervention	11.40 (2.20)	NA	10.3 (0.29)	10.3 (1.9)

Table 5: Transformation from Standard Error to Standard Deviation at follow-up measures of HbA1c. NA = Not applicable.

	Baseline		**Follow-up (6 months post-intervention)**	
	Original M(SD)	**Converted** M(SD)	**Original** M(SE)	**Converted** M(SD)
Experimental Intervention	31.50 (7.00)	NA	30.50 (0.20)	30.5 (1.30)
Control intervention	30.40 (6.80)	NA	30.80 (0.20)	30.80 (1.28)

Table 6: Transformation from Standard Error to Standard Deviation at follow-up measures of BMI. NA = Not applicable.

	Baseline		**Follow-up (6 months post-intervention)**	
	Original M(SD)	**Converted** M(SD)	**Original** M(SE)	**Converted** M(SD)
Experimental Intervention	3.0 (0.90)	NA	103.74(3.12)	103.74(19.98)
Control intervention	3.1 (0.90)	NA	106.86 (3.12)	106.86 (19.98)

Table 7: Transformation from Standard Error to Standard Deviation at follow-up measures of LDL-Cholesterol. NA = Not applicable.

	Baseline		**Follow-up (6 months post-intervention)**	
	Original M(SD)	**Converted** M(SD)	**Original** M(SE)	**Converted** M(SD)
Experimental Intervention	3.0 (0.90)	NA	38.61 (0.78)	38.61 (4.99)
Control intervention	3.10 (0.90)	NA	39 (1.17)	39 (7.49)

Table 8: Transformation from Standard Error to Standard Deviation at follow-up measures of HDL-Cholesterol. NA = Not applicable.

	Baseline		**Follow-up (6 months post-intervention)**	
	Original M(SD)	**Converted** M(SD)	**Original** M(SE)	**Converted** M(SD)
Experimental Intervention	1.40 (1.10 to 1.60)	NA	115.7 (97.90 to 142.40)	115.7 (72.69)
Control intervention	1.40 (1.20 to 1.60)	NA	133.5 (115.70 to 160.20)	133.5 (72.69)

Table 9: Transformation from Confidence Interval (CI to Standard Deviation at follow-up measures of triglycerides. NA = Not applicable.

	Baseline		**Follow-up (6 months post-intervention)**	
	Original M(SD)	**Converted** M(SD)	**Original** M(SE)	**Converted** M(SD)
Experimental Intervention	142.9(22.9)	NA	134.1 (2.9)	134.1 (18.57)
Control intervention	143.3 (28)	NA	130.1 (2.9)	130.1 (18.57)

Table 10: Transformation from Standard Error to Standard Deviation at follow-up measures of systolic blood pressure. NA = Not applicable.

	Baseline		**Follow-up (6 months post-intervention)**	
	Original M(SD)	**Converted** M(SD)	**Original** M(SE)	**Converted** M(SD)

Experimental Intervention	84.3 (11.7)	NA	78.9 (1.5)	78.9 (9.60)
Control intervention	84.5 (11.7)	NA	78.8 (1.5)	78.8 (9.60)

Table 11: Transformation from Standard Error to Standard Deviation at follow-up measures of diastolic blood pressure. NA = Not applicable.

References

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